

DEVELOPMENTAL TRAUMA

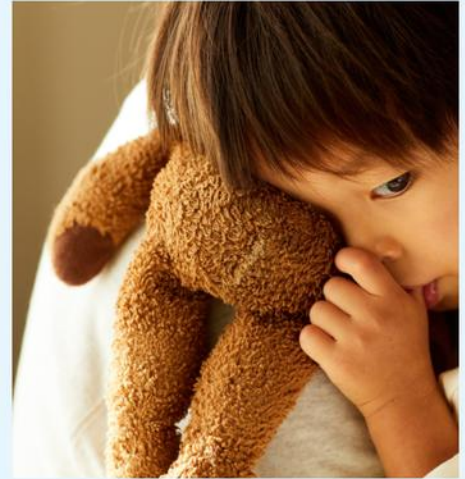
Understanding Early Wounds
Inner Healing 202: Trauma



DEVELOPMENTAL TRAUMA

Trauma arising during childhood and development, especially from caregivers and family systems. This includes: **(1) childhood trauma, (2) neglect trauma, (3) betrayal trauma** involving caregivers, **(4) emotional and psychological trauma** during development, and **(5) generational or intergenerational trauma**.

Key questions: How did early experiences shape beliefs about self, others, and safety? What attachment patterns developed as a result?





CHILDHOOD & NEGLECT TRAUMA

Childhood Trauma



Trauma that occurs during formative years, often involving adverse experiences such as abuse, violence, or instability in the home. Early childhood trauma can deeply shape a child's developing brain, sense of safety, and ability to regulate emotions, influencing beliefs about self and the world.

Neglect Trauma



A form of developmental harm caused by the absence of essential care, nurturing, and emotional attunement from caregivers. Neglect deprives children of the foundational support needed for healthy development, disrupting attachment, self-worth, and the capacity to trust others.



BETRAYAL, EMOTIONAL & PSYCHOLOGICAL TRAUMA



Betrayal Trauma (from Caregivers): Occurs when a trusted caregiver causes harm, violating the child's sense of safety and trust. This form of trauma deeply disrupts attachment bonds, leading to confusion, shame, and difficulty trusting others in later relationships.



Emotional & Psychological Trauma: Chronic exposure to emotional neglect, criticism, or instability during development shapes core beliefs about self-worth and safety. Key questions: How did early experiences shape beliefs about self and others? What attachment patterns developed as a result?

GENERATIONAL OR INTERGENERATIONAL TRAUMA

Generational (or intergenerational) trauma refers to trauma that is passed down through family lines, affecting children and grandchildren of those who experienced it. Patterns of neglect, abuse, or emotional unavailability can repeat across generations without awareness. Key questions include: How did family patterns shape your beliefs about safety and relationships? What behaviors or emotional responses were inherited from caregivers? Healing begins by recognizing these cycles and understanding that they can be broken.

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HOW EARLY EXPERIENCE SHAPE BELIEFS

TYPES OF TRAUMA



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How did early experiences shape beliefs about self, others, and safety? The relationships and environments we encounter in childhood become the blueprint for how we perceive the world. Early trauma — neglect, emotional harm, or betrayal by caregivers — can deeply alter core beliefs about trust, safety, and self-worth, often persisting well into adulthood.

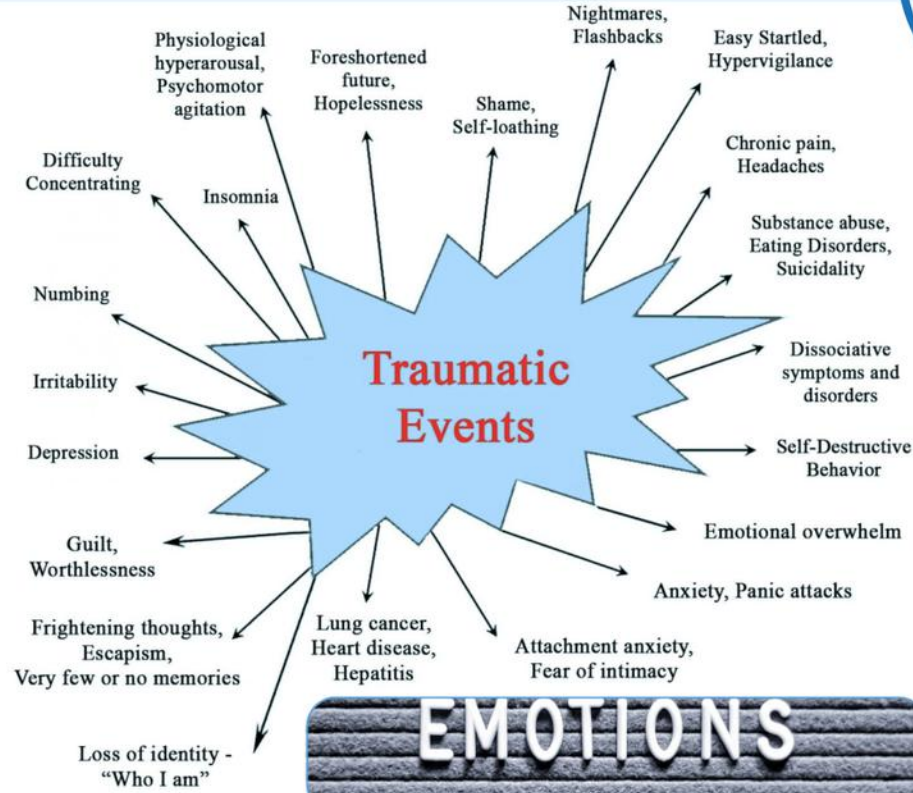
ATTACHMENT PATTERNS



Key Question: What attachment patterns developed? Early experiences with caregivers shape how we relate to others, form bonds, and perceive safety throughout life.

Secure attachment develops when caregivers are consistent and responsive. Insecure styles — anxious, avoidant, or disorganized — often emerge from trauma, neglect, or unpredictable caregiving environments.

LONG-TERM EFFECTS OF DEVELOPMENTAL TRAUMA



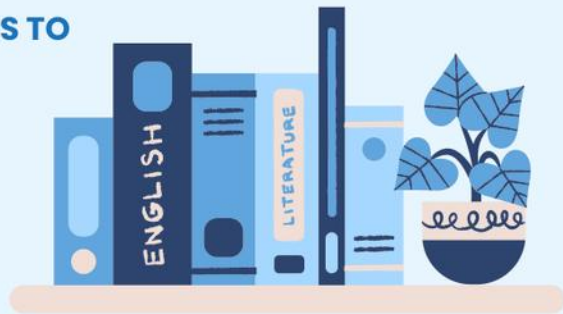
HOPE & HEALING THROUGH GOD

SURRENDERING OUR WOUNDS TO GOD

GOD'S PROMISE:

- GOD WELCOMES THOSE WHO ARE HURTING.
- WE DO NOT HAVE TO CARRY OUR PAIN ALONE.
- HE OFFERS REST, COMFORT, AND STRENGTH FOR THE HEALING JOURNEY.
- SURRENDERING OUR STRUGGLES TO HIM ALLOWS US TO EXPERIENCE HIS PEACE AND GUIDANCE

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GOD'S PROMISE OF RESTORATION

Reflection



Developmental trauma may shape our experiences, but it does not define our identity or our future. God promises healing, restoration, and hope for those who seek Him.

Key Message



When we surrender our pain, fears, and burdens to God, He walks with us in the process of healing and restoration.

**"Cast all your anxiety on Him
because He cares for you."**

— First Epistle of Peter 5:7

Thank You

**"Healing begins when we
acknowledge our wounds and
entrust them to God's loving
care."**

**God's
Promise of
*Restoration***